Rock Stars Help a Music School for Kids Celebrate 25 Years

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Some of rock music's biggest bands came together on Saturday to celebrate a music school for kids. The Silverlake **Conservatory** of Music held a 25th **anniversary benefit concert** at the Hollywood Palladium in Los Angeles. A **benefit concert** raises money for a cause.

The school was founded in 2001 by Flea, the bass player of Red Hot Chili Peppers, along with Keith "Tree" Barry and their friend Peter Weiss. It helps fill gaps in music education in Los Angeles public schools and gives music lessons to 1,000 students each week. Its **scholarship** program helps more than 200 students whose families could not otherwise afford lessons. Those students get free lessons, instruments, supplies and classes.

The night began with the students themselves. A student group called the SCM All Stars played songs including "Love Rollercoaster," and a student brass band called the Hollywood Highsteppers performed too. Because it was Flea's birthday weekend, the brass band played "When the Saints Go Marching In" as he was given a birthday cake on stage.

Anahit, a member of the All Stars, has been taking lessons at the school since she was 6. "Music has always been an **emotional outlet**," she said.

Rapper Vince Staples performed with a band that includes two former students of the school. Dave Grohl then played songs including "My Hero," and his band, Foo Fighters, surprised the crowd by joining him on stage. His daughter Violet sang with them too.

Red Hot Chili Peppers closed the show with an 11-song set, including rare songs they had not played live in many years. The night ended with the crowd singing along to "Give It Away."

"It brings such a good community," Anahit said of the school.

Word Treasure

conservatory -- A conservatory is a school that teaches music.

benefit concert -- A benefit concert is a show held to raise money for a cause.

scholarship -- A scholarship is help that pays for a student's lessons or schooling.

anniversary -- An anniversary is the date each year when something special first happened.

emotional outlet -- An emotional outlet is a healthy way to express your feelings.

Background you need

A music conservatory is a school focused on teaching people to sing or play instruments.

Many public schools have limited music classes, so community music schools can help fill that gap.

Benefit concerts raise money because fans buy tickets and the money goes to a cause, in this case lessons and scholarships for students.

Red Hot Chili Peppers and Foo Fighters are famous rock bands, and Flea, the Chili Peppers' bass player, helped start this school.

Break it down

LEAD: Rock stars play a 25th anniversary benefit for a kids' music school
KEY EVENT: Saturday concert at the Hollywood Palladium in Los Angeles
+- WHO: Red Hot Chili Peppers, Dave Grohl and Foo Fighters, Vince Staples, student bands
+- WHY: to raise money for the Silverlake Conservatory of Music
SCHOOL FACTS: founded in 2001 by Flea and others; 1,000 students a week; scholarships for 200+
HIGHLIGHTS: student performances, Flea's birthday cake, Foo Fighters surprise, rare Chili Peppers songs
STUDENT VOICE: Anahit says music is an emotional outlet and builds community

Why it matters

Music lessons can be expensive, and programs like this help kids who could not otherwise afford them learn to play. The concert shows how famous musicians can use their fame to support young learners.

Test what you remember

1. What was the concert celebrating?

- (A) The opening of a new stadium
- (B) A sports championship
- (C) The Silverlake Conservatory of Music's 25th anniversary
- (D) A new album

2. Which Red Hot Chili Peppers member helped found the school?

- (A) Flea
- (B) Vince Staples
- (C) Dave Grohl
- (D) Anahit

3. How many students does the school teach each week?

- (A) 1,000
- (B) 200
- (C) 11
- (D) 25

4. What do scholarship students receive?

- (A) Free lessons, instruments, supplies and classes
- (B) A trip to Europe
- (C) A new phone
- (D) Concert tickets only

5. Who opened the night?

- (A) Students from the school
- (B) Red Hot Chili Peppers
- (C) A comedian
- (D) Foo Fighters

6. Which song did the crowd sing along to at the end?

- (A) When the Saints Go Marching In
- (B) My Hero
- (C) Love Rollercoaster
- (D) Give It Away

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: A 3: A 4: A 5: A 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Anahit, a student: She says music has always been an emotional outlet and that the school builds a strong community.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):